MAHIMA SACHAN

Forward Deployed Engineer | Agentic AI | Enterprise Deployments

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SUMMARY

Forward Deployed Engineer with **6+ years** at **Microsoft** and **Salesforce** shipping production systems used by **300M+ people**, now building **GenAI** and **agentic AI** systems (LLMs, AI agents, **RAG**) for enterprise customers. I own customer outcomes end to end: mapping messy enterprise processes, integrating with existing systems, and shipping evaluated **LLM and agent workflows** that people use every day.

EXPERIENCE

Aithon Tech Inc — Founding Forward Deployed Engineer *Aug 2026 – Present*

- Owned kickoffs, trainings and deployments for **6 enterprise customers** (Finastra, USAN, AutoRABIT, Aivar, Liminal, Wizr) with sales VPs and ops leads, driving pilots to daily use.
- Diagnosed low platform adoption by interviewing end users directly, uncovering workflow misfit, interface complexity and output-quality gaps; turned the findings into a **roadmap** and drove it **cross-functionally** with engineering, UX/design and product.
- Redesigned core UI workflows from user research, lifting **weekly active users 50%** and cutting time-to-first-value from **3 weeks to 2 days**.
- Improved lead quality for sellers by adding data enrichment and buying signals, then built **lead scoring** that ranks leads on 4 metrics: product fit, timing, budget and competitive intel.

Stealth Startup — Forward Deployed Engineer *May 2026 – Aug 2026*

- Sole FDE deploying **AI phone agents** for **healthcare, insurance, and home-services** enterprises, live in **under 3 weeks**.
- Designed **call flows, prompts, and function calls** (booking, transfers, lookups) for multi-step inbound/outbound calls.
- Integrated agents with **CRMs, EHRs, calendars, and telephony (Twilio, SIP)** via webhooks; cut latency to **under 800 ms**.
- Built **simulated-call test suites** and post-call analysis, raising call resolution from **62% to 85%**; ran demos and onboarding with sales and fed customer needs back into the product.

California State University, Long Beach — Graduate Research Assistant *Sep 2025 – May 2026*

- Built **VOICE-GuardEval**, a severity-aware **evaluation framework** for **voice agents** (ASR/TTS) grading action correctness, clarification, confirmation and cancellation on a **τ-Voice-inspired dataset**; raised task success from **69% to ~95%** and cut **severe failures to 1%**.

Microsoft — Product Manager 2, Purview Data Lifecycle Management *Dec 2023 – Jan 2025*

- Built a **customer support agent** for Purview, a data governance and compliance platform protecting **317M monthly users** (5K+ tickets, 500+ escalations a month), cutting **time-in-escalation 22%** and **total tickets 30%** with **agentic workflows**.
- Unblocked **$7M+** in **Fortune 500** financial-services deals by delivering regulatory-compliance features, including **SEC 17a-4** deletion audit.
- Worked directly with **350+ enterprise customers** and **cross-functionally** with engineering, UX/design and product teams, turning ambiguous requirements into specs and shipped features: retention modification, auto-labeling, and **Microsoft Graph APIs** driving **5M+ calls a month**.
- Defined the **Deeply Protected Users KPI** from usage telemetry (KQL) and put it on the executive dashboard to guide portfolio investment.

Microsoft — Software Engineer II, AI Graph / Meeting Insights *Mar 2022 – Dec 2023*

- Integrated **LLM summarization** and intent extraction (**Azure OpenAI**) with prompt templates, **hallucination detection**, **PII scanning** and quality tracking in production.
- Built multi-source ingestion and ranking pipelines (documents, email, meetings, chat) with chunking, hybrid indexing and multi-tier caching for low-latency **semantic search** serving **300M+ daily active users**.
- Cut service **memory footprint 30%** through heap-dump profiling, object pooling and streaming deserialization, improving throughput and stability.

Microsoft — Software Engineer, Windows 11 Voice Access *Dec 2020 – Feb 2022*

- Led the **Voice Access** first-run experience (**C++**, Windows Speech Platform, UI Automation) with intent recognition and app-state grounding, shipped to **1B+ devices**.
- Built a **WCAG 2.1 AA** accessible UI framework (XAML, WinUI) that passed every accessibility review for screen readers, keyboard navigation and high-contrast themes.

Salesforce — Member of Technical Staff, Marketing Cloud *Jun 2019 – Dec 2020*

- Built **REST APIs** and **.NET** orchestration tooling that automated patching and decommissioning across **10K servers**, cutting a **6-day manual process to seconds** and saving **5 engineer-days** per cycle.
- Shipped a self-serve orchestration UI with **GDPR-compliant** US/EU regional routing for non-technical ops teams.

PROJECTS

- **Autonomous Multi-Agent Trading Floor:** 4 collaborating agents on 6 MCP servers and 44 tools that research markets, evaluate positions and run simulated trades with full audit trails (CrewAI, LangGraph).
- **Deep Research Multi-Agent System:** planner–researcher–writer agents with shared memory and reflection loops that break a topic into sub-questions, research in parallel and write cited reports (LangGraph).
- **Multi-Modal Airline Support Agent:** chat agent with function-calling tools for booking lookup, flight status and image-based document understanding, with tool routing and structured outputs.
- **RAG Knowledge Worker:** answers domain questions over company documents with citations; tuned chunking, embeddings and reranking (FastAPI, FAISS, Docker on AWS).

SKILLS

- **GenAI, Agentic AI & LLMs:** multi-agent systems (LangGraph, CrewAI, AutoGen), MCP, function calling, webhooks, RAG, vector search, embeddings, prompt engineering, LLM/agent evals, LoRA fine-tuning, voice agents (STT/TTS, call flows); Claude, GPT-4, Gemini, Llama
- **Languages:** Python, C#, C++, Java, JavaScript/TypeScript, Go, SQL
- **Backend & Data:** FastAPI, Flask, Node.js, .NET/ASP.NET Core, Spring Boot, REST, Elasticsearch, Kafka, Snowflake, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, vector DBs (FAISS, Pinecone, Chroma)
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS (Bedrock, Lambda, S3, SQS, Step Functions, EC2), Azure, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD
- **Customer-facing:** discovery, solution design, demos, onboarding and training, stakeholder management with sales VPs and ops leads
- **Security & Compliance:** OAuth2, RBAC, GDPR, SEC 17a-4, PII handling

EDUCATION

California State University, Long Beach — M.S., Computer Science, GPA 4.00/4.00 *Jan 2025 – Dec 2026*

Motilal Nehru National Institute of Technology — B.Tech., Computer Science, GPA 3.89/4.00 *Jul 2015 – May 2019*

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Anthropic (Mar 2026):** Claude Code in Action; Introduction to Subagents; Introduction to Agent Skills; Introduction to Claude Cowork
- **Educative (2026):** Forward Deployed Engineer for AI Systems (May); LLM Evaluation: Building Reliable AI Systems at Scale (Jun)
- **Earlier:** Team Kanban Practitioner, Kanban University (2019); System Design, Coding Ninjas (2022, Top Performer); Machine Learning, Coding Ninjas (2018); Algo++ Advanced Data Structures & Algorithms in C++, Coding Blocks (2017)

PUBLICATIONS

- Manoharan Jayanthi, R.R., **Sachan, M.**, Rathi, B., Chhangani, M.D., & Mandyam Rangarajan, A. (2026). *Measuring Provenance Sensitivity in Tool-Using LLM Agents Reveals Channel-Dependent Safety Behavior.* NewInML Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026 (Poster). openreview.net/forum?id=Tpdf0bhEDg
- **Sachan, M.**, et al. (2026). *Women's Role in Software Engineering — An Empirical Study.* SEET 2025, CCIS vol. 2725, pp. 430–445, Springer. doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-08977-9_27
- **Sachan, M.**, Abbaraju, S., & Paliwal, M. (2018). *Internet of Things: Raspberry Pi Home Automation System based on IoT.* Medium.

AWARDS & LEADERSHIP

- **Microsoft** Global Hackathon 2022 Award Winner: 3rd place of ~800 participants (Hyderabad, Dec 2022).
- WDX India Star Award, **Microsoft** (Jun 2021) for quality and craftsmanship on **Voice Access**; Spot Bonus at **Salesforce** Marketing Cloud.
- **Women in Tech Lead, Windows (Microsoft):** led Women in Tech initiatives for the Windows team, running events that built community and visibility for women engineers.
- **Mentor, Being Zero:** mentored women students to crack SDE interviews; mentees were placed at Google, Adobe and JPMorgan Chase.